Plain pewter buttons

Trousers
During the Peninsular War, the light infantryman's white breeches and black gaiters gave way to the grey versions shown here. Made of thick wool, they were stiflingly hot in summer.

Buttons were cleaned with brick dust and ammonia

Bayonet and canteen behind left arm

Fastening woollen gaiter

Shoes alternated by soldiers to keep them "straight lasted"

Gaiters
In the absence of boots, gaiters were worn to keep stones out of shoes. They were buttoned from the knee to the ankle and were worn beneath the trousers.

Leather strap for looping under shoe

Shoes
Shoes were issued "straight-lasted" (with neither left nor right) and were often of extremely poor quality. Only two pairs were issued to a soldier each year.

Soles were often only glued to the shoe